



FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
LONDON BUSINESS SCHOOL

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO LBS

ABOUT THE SCHOOL

On the heels of its new curriculum debut in 2017, London Business School touts itself as "the world's most flexible MBA." Just as London has become one of the world's great cities, so the London Business School has transformed into one of the world's finest business schools.

A top-flight center of teaching and research, the school's MBA program often ranks #1 in Europe, and is seen as the international alternative to the finance-focused business schools of the US. Blue-chip firms from consultancy to finance to industry fight to recruit 400 graduates every year, for placement in positions not only in the UK and Europe, but also in the Middle East, Africa and Asia.

The culture and economy of London are at the heart of the LBS experience, and the student body reflects such a cosmopolitan city with more than 70 nationalities in the MBA classroom. LBS admissions is looking for a diverse but balanced class, with no dominant culture.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Finance, Strategy, Entrepreneurship, Global Business Experience, Real Estate, Media, Marketing, Energy. Career placement and deep roots in international financial markets

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants: 2,452 MBA Class Size: 485
Admissions Selectivity: 32.8% Yield: 60.30%
Total Tuition: £82,000

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Consulting 37%; Finance 23%; Technology 23%; Consumer & Retail 6%
Top Recruiters: BCG, McKinsey, Bain and Co., Strategy&, A.T Kearney, Amazon, Accenture
Avg. base salary: \$106,120 Employment within 3 months: 93%

MBA RANKINGS	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	1	-	3	-	1	2	2	3
Financial Times	1	1	1	2	3	3	2	2
Forbes	-	4	-	1	-	1	-	1
The Economist	3	3	3	24	25	7	6	6

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Age: 29 yrs Avg. GMAT: 708
Female Students: 39% Int'l Students: 91%

Deadlines for Sept 2019: R1 - Sep 13, '19 R2 - Jan 3, '20
R3 - Mar 5, '20 R4 - Apr 22, '20

COVID-19 Changes to Admissions: As of March 13, 2020, LBS will accept applications without exams (GMAT, GRE, EA or TOEFL score). LBS asks candidates to submit older scores if they have them, and the expectation is that applicants will continue prep and take the exam when centers reopen.

Sources: LBS, BusinessWeek, U.S. News & World Report, Financial Times, The Economist, MBA50



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ESSAYS 2019-2020:

1. What are your post-MBA plans and how will your prior experience and the London Business School programme contribute towards these? (500 words)
2. (Optional) Is there any other information you believe the Admissions Committee should know about you and your application to London Business School? (500 words)



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By Emma Bond

Emma joined the London Business School MBA Marketing and Admissions team in 2001 with initial responsibility for recruiting from Africa, Asia and the Middle East; quickly, she became one of the core senior members of the LBS Admissions Committee, responsible for full-time MBA selection. In 2008, Emma became the European Recruiting Manager for the Boston Consulting Group. At BCG, she led recruitment of London Business School MBA students into BCG's global offices and was also responsible for advising associates applying to LBS.

Tip #1 - Conveying your passion for LBS

London Business School is one of the leading business schools in Europe, located close to the heart of the London financial market and broader European economy. It competes with INSEAD to offer career opportunities in the corporate sector, consulting, technology and media. For those applicants looking to move ahead in the world of finance, it also competes with US schools such as Wharton, Columbia, Harvard and Chicago Booth.

In this competitive environment, the admissions office is constantly looking for evidence of your commitment to the school. If at all possible, try to visit LBS before you submit your application. The admissions team offers a number of options for candidates; in addition to monthly London Information Sessions, you can also attend a 'drop-in' session each week or book in to take part in a class. All of these opportunities give you invaluable time with current students and staff – this will help you decide if the school is truly right for you. If you manage to speak with one of the admissions team it may get you on their radar as a strong candidate, and it means you can include your visit on the application form, which in turn helps reinforce your commitment to the school. If you can't visit campus, try and attend one of the many Information Sessions LBS holds in different countries around the world each year.

Tip #2 - Overcoming a lower than average GPA

Like all top schools, LBS is looking for smart candidates who can cope with rigorous coursework. To that end, your previous academics are definitely relevant and a strong GPA and good undergraduate degree are important. But LBS also prides itself on a really diverse and well-rounded class, so the Admissions Committee looks carefully at the whole person by considering work experience, essays and references, not just the key numbers.

If you have a good reason for your lower GPA, make sure you get that across in the optional essay. If you have other skills/professional qualifications that can help demonstrate your academic potential, make those known. And, importantly, if you have a low GPA you should ensure you prepare well for the GMAT; the score you achieve and submit will be that much more significant in the final decision and can mitigate the risk presented by lower grades.

Tip #3 - When to apply

It's definitely preferable to apply for R1 or R2. While European business schools have a more even distribution of places across the different rounds compared to the top US schools, LBS often uses R4 to complete its class with the desired number of UK candidates. By rounds 3 and 4 there are far fewer spots left, most having been dished out to the strong, well-prepared candidates who applied in Rounds 1 and 2. In addition, if you wait until later rounds you will also be running up against waitlisted candidates from earlier rounds – the waitlist is reviewed regularly throughout the year and then again before each admission offer point. That said, there is always room for stellar candidates so if you come to the MBA decision late in the application year, LBS can be a good option when others have already filled their class lists.



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Tip #4 – Remember that 'global' is not just a word, it's a culture

There's no doubt that LBS is a truly international business school. It's based in a supremely multicultural city, and less than 10% of the class is British. But at LBS, global is more than just a word – it's a culture that is woven through the fabric of the entire institution. The school is continually reinventing the curriculum to best represent this focus, most recently including the Global Business Experiences immersion week as part of its core MBA offering. So it's no longer enough just to state confidently that you've backpacked across Europe – the admissions committee will be closely scrutinizing your application to see exactly what global flavor you'll bring to the new class. Internationalism can take many forms. Have you worked on international projects or liaised often with international clients? Do you work on multi-cultural teams? Have you invested time in learning other languages? Are there any global secondment opportunities coming up at your company?

Any and all of these things can add weight to your application. Serious LBS applicants will have worked, lived and travelled on multiple continents, so if the international aspect of the LBS experience is what drew you to the school in the first place, make sure you sell that side of yourself. Getting across your passion for travel, for experiencing other cultures and for working in a global capacity post-graduation is crucial. And if you are thinking about applying to LBS in a year or two and have not yet travelled, get out there and do it!

Tip #5 – Contribution to the program and alumni network

LBS' students are very active in community-related events – social, sports, and clubs. The Admissions team is looking for candidates who will participate and lead these activities enthusiastically and contribute beyond as alumni. So, you need to have demonstrated similar energy and dedication to activities outside of your professional life. Admissions will want to understand how you will play a role on-campus and how you envision contributing; this is where the value of visiting LBS and knowing it well will also pay off. The more specific and authentic you can be, the better.

Tip #6 – Wild card admissions

Like many other schools, LBS brings in the bulk of its MBA class from tried and tested routes. Each year, candidates with a background in finance, consulting and corporate sectors make up a big chunk of the class, along with a smattering of entrepreneurs. But LBS loves to celebrate the eclectic nature of its community and there are always a good number of students transitioning from less traditional areas, like medicine, teaching, and increasingly, the military. Now and then, the LBS admissions committee will also take a punt on a real wild card – maybe someone who hasn't completed a degree, or who is without the standard 2-3 years of work experience. Rest assured though, that if you are an outlier in one aspect of your application, then the rest of it – including the GMAT, essays and references – needs to be absolutely stellar.

Tip #7 – It's not just a finance school

LBS has a strong tradition in finance, supported by its superb position close to the City of London, top finance faculty, and exceptional links with global finance recruiters. But ongoing rankings success has ensured that the admissions pipeline, and consequently graduate career choice, is becoming increasingly diverse. LBS now has a stable in and out pipeline from top consulting firms like BCG and McKinsey, while tech recruiters like Amazon and Google have become increasingly visible on campus. So don't be afraid to explore and sell yourself on less traditional career paths. Just be realistic about your aims and remember to reference transferable skills from your existing experience which link to your future goals.

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Tip #8 – Demonstrating collegiality

Like other business schools full of high-caliber students, the LBS MBA program has a competitive element. But internally it also enjoys a very collegial campus atmosphere, something that is enhanced by having a smaller class than some of its competitors. Teamwork is key and students actively work to support each other in weaker coursework elements. The current essay topics, particularly Essay 2, are a perfect opportunity for you to demonstrate your understanding of this facet of LBS life. Think of value-add not just in simple terms like club involvement, but also on a deeper level, as it relates to the experience and skill set you can offer fellow classmates.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances for admission, reserve yours at: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

